Cast of Characters

(in alphabetical order)

ASHE, ROBERT WILLIAM D'ESCOURT (1872–1911). Sub-collector and joint magistrate of Tuticorin subdivision at the time of the Tirunelveli 'Riots'. Assassinated by Vanchi, member of a secret nationalist group.

BHARATI, SUBRAMANIA C. (1882–1921). Foremost Tamil poet of the twentieth century. Editor of the nationalist weekly, *India*. VOC's friend and great champion of SSNCo.

CHIDAMBARAM PILLAI, V.O. (1872–1936). The hero of this story. Small-town pleader. Launches the Swadeshi Steam Navigation Company.

DEVADOSS PILLAI, M.D. (1868–1951). Director of SSNCo. Barrister. Judge of Madras High Court (1921–1928).

GURUSWAMI AIYAR, K.R. High Court lawyer. Moderate Congressman. Honorary legal adviser to SSNCo. VOC's foremost rival in the company.

KRISHNA AIYANGAR, S.D. (?–1926). Honorary secretary of SSNCo. After VOC's arrest, helms the company in the face of great adversities.

LAWLEY, ARTHUR (1860–1932). Governor of Madras Presidency (March 1906–November 1911) during the Swadeshi movement. Fully backs the local administration's vindictive action against SSNCo.

MEENAKSHI (1889–1951). Wife of VOC. Undergoes untold sufferings after her husband is jailed.